

dBm

Decibels compared to one milliwatt. A wireless networking device's transmitting and receiving powers are often measured in decibel strength compared to one milliwatt of power. The higher the dBm, the greater the device's transmitting or receiving power.

DES

Data Encryption Standard. DES is an encryption method originally developed by IBM in the 1970s. Certified by the US government for the transmission of any data that is not classified top-secret, DES uses an algorithm for private-key encryption, in which the sender uses the same private key to send the message that the recipient uses to decode it.

The key consists of 56 bits of data, which are transformed and combined with each 64-bit block of the data to be sent. DES is fairly weak with only one iteration, and repeating it using slightly different keys can provide excellent security.

DHCP

Domain Host Control Protocol. DHCP is a protocol for dynamically assigning IP addresses to networked computers. With DHCP, a computer can automatically be given a unique IP address each time it connects to a network, making IP address management easier for network administrators. When a computer logs on to the network, the DHCP server selects an IP address from a master list and assigns it to the system.

Dipole Antenna

A type of antenna commonly used with wireless networking devices. It has a signal range of 360 degrees horizontally and 75 degrees vertically. It works best in offices, away from exterior walls where signals could leak out.

Directional Antenna

Defines several types of antennas that redirect the signal received from a transmitter to enhance its strength in a certain direction, unlike an omni-directional antenna.